



SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

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IE 7 AND ADD-ONS

The latest version of Internet Explorer has significantly evolved from its earlier iterations with enhanced features, improved security and crisper looks.

In terms of extending the features of the basic browser, IE 7 can be coupled with add-ons, which though not as numerous as Firefox, still does a pretty good job.

Favourites

IE 7 has newer features and more options when it comes to organising your favourites. The Favorite items represented by a bright yellow five-pointed star.

Shortcuts

Keyboard shortcuts make your job easier, especially when you use heavy software. IE has its own long list, and recalling them will do you good.

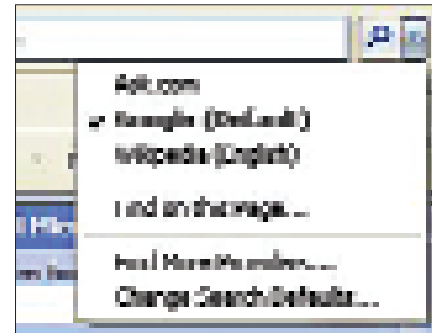
Go back to the last page	[Alt] + [Left Arrow]
Go forward to the next page	[Alt] + [Right Arrow]
Focus the Address Bar	[Alt] + [D]
Add site to favorites	[Ctrl] + [D]
Open the right click context menu for selected item	[Shift] + [F10]
Open links in a background tab	[Ctrl] + [Click/Middle-click]
Close current tab	[Ctrl] + [W]/Middle-click on the tab
Switch to the last tab	[Ctrl] + [9]
Close other tabs	[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [F4]
Open quick tabs	[Ctrl] + [Q]
Go to the search box	[Ctrl] + [E]
Open search query in new Tab	[Alt] + [Enter]
Bring down the search provider menu	[Ctrl] + [Down Arrow]
Open Favorites Center to your favourites	[Ctrl] + [I]
Open a new tab	[Ctrl] + [T]/Double click on the tab bar
Zoom the page	Ctrl + [+], [-] / [Ctrl] + scroll wheel
Display classic menu items	[Alt]

Bookmarks

The bookmark toolbar is very useful for obvious reasons, but there is no such toolbar enabled by default in IE 7. To enable it, hit the [Alt] key and go to View > Toolbars > Links. Drag and drop the icons from the address bar or even a link from a Web page. The new links are visible once you click on the arrow at the extreme right of the toolbar. Deleting the bookmarks is as easy as right clicking and then clicking on the Delete button.

Search

Similar to Firefox, Microsoft has thankfully ditched its Windows Live Search functionality by allowing users to use other search engines. To use this function, click on the arrow labelled



Now use search engines of your choice

Search Options, which is located at the right of the search box. A drop down menu will appear, with options for adding other search engines. Click on the Find More Providers. Select from a list of search engines comprising Google, Ask, Lycos, Wikipedia and Amazon. Click on any of these to install them. Although the list is long, in case you don't find your favourite search engine, enter the URL in the text field to install it to your browser.

If you have disabled the Google toolbar, you can search for any item without typing it in the search box. Just type your search string in the address bar itself. If it consists of more than one word, the Google search page will be displayed automatically with all the results. Depending on the string, if an exact match is found the browser redirects you to the first result, otherwise accessible by the "I am feeling lucky" button.

Manage Add-ons

Apart from third party add-ons, which you can install for productivity, IE comes with add-ons such as Java and Adobe Reader. Whenever you notice a reduction in browsing speeds, check the memory consumed by IE in the Task Manager. In case it's extremely high, disable all the add-ons installed from Tools > Internet Options > Programs > Manage add-ons. However, you need Windows XP Service Pack 2 installed for this. Look through the list and disable all add-ons such as Browser Helper Objects and Browser Extensions. You can enable these later, if you want to. Also, be a little more wary while installing add-ons that are ActiveX objects. These have the nasty reputation of triggering security holes.

Editing The Registry

There are certain hacks in the registries that can make IE 7 look more like IE6 in terms of the positioning of the menu bar. Proceed with care: the usual statutory warnings when it comes to registry editing apply here.

Go to Start > Run and type